

Dhruv Nirmal

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Hiring Manager, Australian Venue Co., Melbourne VIC

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Commercial Optimisation Analyst - Food & Beverage role. What drew me to it is that the work is exactly what I already do: take a messy, ambiguous commercial question, figure out what analysis actually answers it, and stay with the project until the recommendation is implemented and the result is measurable. The scale of the opportunity across 250+ venues, with real pressure to move the margin needle, is the kind of environment where that kind of work has the most impact.

The most directly relevant engagement I have run is a pricing and margin project for a restaurant chain operating across Australia and New Zealand. I owned it end-to-end as the sole analyst: built a structured product catalog of roughly 3,000 to 3,500 items, a pricing-decision dashboard tracking category-level price movement so the procurement team could negotiate better supplier deals (the view showed potential savings vs. money lost on unfavourable deals, drilled to product, venue, and supplier), and a second dashboard flagging where a cheaper substitute product was available. I ran the client relationship directly, presenting findings in bi-weekly and monthly meetings with the CFO, Chief Procurement Officer, and category managers. Over a year, that work helped the client identify approximately A\$2M in savings in their largest category, around 30% of that category spend. That is food-business cost and margin analysis at the category and venue level, with a direct line from the analysis to a negotiation to a measurable outcome.

Beyond the client work, I have built Facit (myfacit.com), a multi-tenant SaaS I designed specifically for independent cafes. It pulls together POS transactions, staff wages, and 14 suppliers' invoices into a single model and gives owners a weekly pulse: revenue, wage cost %, food cost %, gross margin, one recommended action, menu engineering signals showing which items drive margin and which erode it, and supplier price-creep alerts flagging rising input costs before they show up in the P&L. The design partner is Dom, owner of Neighbours Cafe in St Kilda, a real cafe with 20 staff and unintegrated systems. Building it around messy real-world data and a non-technical operator has been the most instructive thing I have done on how hospitality businesses actually track and act on profitability. On the tooling side, I deliver across Power BI, Tableau, Python, and SQL, and I have shipped agentic AI workflows in production.

What makes AVC particularly interesting is that I both advise on and build hospitality margin tooling: I have done the client-facing commercial analysis at scale, and I have built the product that operationalises it for operators who need to act on it every week. Bringing that combination to a portfolio of 250+ venues, where the same margin and menu insights need to be repeatable and implementable across a complex multi-site business, is exactly the work I want to be doing. I would welcome the chance to discuss the role further. You can reach me at dhruvnirmal2111@gmail.com or +61 406 259 619.

Yours sincerely,

Dhruv Nirmal